Northwind Analytics Remote Work Policy

Version 3.2. This policy applies to all full-time and part-time employees of Northwind Analytics, a fictional data consulting company. Contractors are covered by their individual service agreements instead.

Purpose. The purpose of this policy is to allow employees to work from locations other than the office while keeping client data secure and maintaining reliable collaboration across teams.

Eligibility. Employees become eligible for remote work after completing a 90-day onboarding period. Managers may approve exceptions for employees who relocate for family reasons. Roles that require handling physical client equipment, such as the hardware lab technicians, are not eligible for full-time remote work.

Work Arrangements

Northwind offers three arrangements. The hybrid arrangement requires at least two office days per week, normally Tuesday and Thursday. The fully remote arrangement requires one in-person team week per quarter. The flexible arrangement lets employees choose their office days, subject to team coverage rules.

Core collaboration hours are from 10:00 to 15:00 in the employee's home office time zone. During core hours employees are expected to be reachable on the company chat tool within 30 minutes.

Employees who want to work from another country for more than 14 consecutive days must request approval from the People Operations team at least four weeks in advance, because of tax and data protection rules.

Equipment and Expenses

Each remote employee receives a one-time home office stipend of 600 euros to buy a desk, a chair or other ergonomic equipment. Receipts must be submitted within 60 days of purchase.

The company provides a laptop, a monitor and a headset. Company laptops must use full-disk encryption and must not be shared with family members or other people.

Northwind reimburses internet costs of up to 35 euros per month for employees on the fully remote arrangement. Coworking space memberships are reimbursed up to 150 euros per month when approved by the employee's manager in advance.

Security Requirements

Client data may only be accessed through the company VPN. Employees must never store client data on personal devices or personal cloud storage accounts. Public Wi-Fi networks may be used only while the VPN is connected.

Security incidents, including a lost or stolen laptop, must be reported to the IT security team within 4 hours by emailing the security desk or calling the incident hotline.

Policy review. This policy is reviewed every 12 months by People Operations together with the IT security team. Questions about the policy should be sent to People Operations.